Alexander Joseph Almeida

CONTACT INFORMATION

Graduate School of Business
Stanford University
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FIELDS OF INTEREST

Econometrics, Causal Inference, Machine Learning

EDUCATION

Stanford University, Stanford, CA
Ph.D., Economic Policy, Graduate School of Business — 2024 – 2030 (expected)
Advisors: Guido Imbens, Lihua Lei
M.S., Statistics — 2024 – 2027 (expected)
Research Fellow, Graduate School of Business — 2022 – 2024
Fellowships & Awards: EDGE Doctoral Fellowship (Stanford VPGE)

Arizona State University – Barrett, The Honors College, Tempe, AZ
B.S. Economics & B.S. Mathematics, GPA: 4.00/4.00 — 2018 – 2022
Honors: Dean's Medal – Economics (Most Outstanding Graduate), Jonathan D. and Helen Wexler Award (Top 12 Seniors in Mathematics), Moeur Award (8 semesters above 4.0), Phi Beta Kappa, Beta Gamma Sigma
Scholarships: National Hispanic Scholar (Full Tuition), IGNITE Fellowship – Teach for America, Grady Gammage Scholarship, Earl & Ellen Davis Memorial Scholarship, SCETL Founders' Scholarship, Business School Scholarship

WORKING PAPERS

Almeida, Alexander, Susan Athey, Guido Imbens, Eva Lestant, and Alexia Olaizola. "Estimating Variances for Causal Panel Data Estimators." *arXiv:2510.11841*, October 2025.

- Develops a unified framework for variance estimation in causal panel data settings; shows that the three main approaches (regression-based, unit-placebo, and time-placebo) each target a different conditional variance under distinct exchangeability assumptions, and proposes a new heteroskedasticity-robust estimator with superior statistical power

Almeida, Alexander, and Lihua Lei. "Compound Selection with Heteroskedastic Errors of Unknown Variance." *Work in progress.*

- Develops an empirical Bayes approach to compound selection decisions, extending prior work by Lei et al. to settings where observation variances are unknown; relaxes the known-variance assumption in Stein's unbiased risk estimation to handle heteroskedastic data

"Inference for Nonlinear Latent Regressors." *Work in progress.*

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Stanford Graduate School of Business, Stanford, CA
Research Fellow – supervised by Prof. Rebecca Diamond and Prof. Guido Imbens Jun. 2022 – Jun. 2024

- Developed heteroskedasticity-robust variance estimators for causal panel data settings, unifying regression-based, unit-placebo, and time-placebo approaches under a common exchangeability framework
- Constructed and managed terabyte-scale administrative data pipelines supporting empirical research in labor and public economics

- Contributed to three publications in labor and public economics (Garrett, Ohrn, Suárez Serrato; Curtis et al.; Suárez Serrato, Wingender)

Federal Reserve Bank of Dallas, Dallas, TX
Research Intern – supervised by Dr. Ali Ozdagli Jun. 2021 – Aug. 2021

- Authored two original blog posts for the Dallas Fed Economics blog drawing on research on firm financing and monetary policy transmission
- Developed a literature review on environmental risk in financial markets

Future H2O Economic Research, Tempe, AZ
Research Assistant – supervised by Prof. W. Michael Hanemann Mar. 2021 – May 2022

- Investigated hedonic property valuation of ecological attributes in Texas flood basins

College of Health Solutions: Behavioral Health Research Lab, Tempe, AZ
Research Assistant – supervised by Prof. Chad Stecher Sep. 2020 – May 2022

- Designed and implemented a randomized controlled experiment to evaluate behavioral automaticity
- Applied machine learning methods to large mobile-health databases

Presentations

2026 SC2 Student Conference (scheduled, November 6); Empirical Methods in the Age of AI (poster)

Teaching

Arizona State University – Economics Department, Tempe, AZ
Teaching Assistant – Foundations of Microeconomics Oct. 2019 – Jan. 2021

- Assisted in developing coursework for a distance-learning MOOC platform serving over 800 students

Arizona State University Academic Success Programs, Tempe, AZ
Tutor – Economics, Finance, Mathematics Feb. 2020 – Feb. 2021

Skills

Computing: Bash, Python, R, Stata, Julia, MATLAB, C++, Java, LaTeX, SQL; some experience in PyTorch, Tableau

Languages: English (native), Spanish (fluent)

Service & Affiliations

- **Gammage Scholarship Program** – Chair and Project Leader, service-based leadership program for National Merit Scholars (2018–2022)
- **RISE Tutoring** – Finance Committee Head, Refugee Integration Stabilization and Education Scholars; recipient of ASU Pitchfork Award for outstanding student organizations (2019–2022)